An Evening for Two

Lean on *Me*

A conversation about trust and commitment

Under a glass roof,
beneath a silver-leafed tree

For Thao & Aaron

Why this date matters

Trust isn't one big promise. It builds up from small moments: a text answered, a plan kept, a bad day you listened to without trying to fix it. Over time those moments turn into a quiet sense that *this person is on my side*.

Commitment is the choice that grows out of that. You keep picking each other, and you protect what you're building even when it would be easier not to.

This date isn't for big announcements. It's a chance to talk openly about what makes each of you feel safe, what you need from each other, and what "being there" really looks like.

The spirit of the evening

- Be curious, not careful. Ask the follow-up question.
- Listen to understand, not to answer. Solving can wait.
- There are no wrong answers, only honest ones.
- Take turns. Each of you answers every question.
- Put the phones away, face down or in a bag.

Preparing

Each of you spends ten quiet minutes on your own with these questions before you meet. You don't need to write anything down, just let them settle.

- Who in your life could you always count on, and what did they do that made you feel that way?
- Think of a time someone let you down. What did you learn about what you need?
- What does trust feel like in your body: calm, lightness, ease?
- What's one small thing your partner has already done that made you feel cared for?

The plan

Where	A secret for now. Think of a hidden garden under a glass roof, with soft teal booths, climbing greenery, and a pale tree glowing in the middle. It comes from a plant-based kitchen the Michelin Guide has praised. The address comes on the day.
When	Arrive at 7 pm, when the glass roof goes dark and the tree lights up.
Before	A short walk along the leafy old streets nearby to settle in.
Dress	Optional. Come as you are, straight from your day. If there happens to be time, soft greens or creams suit the room beautifully.

Where trust comes from

Start gently, with your stories.

1. Growing up, who was the person you could always lean on? What made them so reliable?
2. What did your family teach you, out loud or not, about keeping promises?
3. When did you first learn that trust can break? How did that shape you?
4. Are you someone who trusts quickly, or slowly and carefully? Why do you think that is?
5. What's a small, ordinary moment in which you felt completely safe with someone?

A small ritual: Raise your cups to one person who taught each of you what trust feels like. Say their name and one thing they did, then take a quiet sip together.

Trust between us

Now bring it closer to home.

1. What's something I've done so far that made you feel you could count on me?
2. What does "showing up" look like to you on an ordinary Tuesday, not a big day?
3. When you're stressed or sad, what helps most: space, a hug, food, distraction, or just someone listening?
4. Is there anything that would quietly worry you, even if it seems small?
5. How do you like to hear from me when we're apart?
6. When you need something from me, how will I know? What would make it easier for you to ask?

Choosing each other

Look ahead, without pressure.

1. What does commitment mean to you: a feeling, a decision, or a habit?
2. Which couples do you admire, and what do they do well?
3. What's one thing we could protect, no matter how busy life gets? It could be a ritual, a night of the week, or a tradition.
4. When we disagree someday, what do you hope we'll always remember?
5. What's a promise, big or small, you'd like to make tonight?

A small ritual: Each of you finishes this sentence out loud: *"You can count on me to..."*

Our agreement

Write down one small, real thing each of you will do to build trust over the next month. Keep it simple: a daily goodnight message, being on time, one evening a week without phones.

I'll show up by...

You'll show up by...

"We choose to be a safe place for each other, in the small moments and the big ones."

Thao

Aaron

Keep it going

- Take a slow walk afterwards, maybe for a hot chocolate, and let the conversation wind down on its own.
- Within a week, follow through on your agreement in some small, visible way.
- One month later, check in over coffee and ask, "How are we doing with this?"

Notes from tonight